higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

BUSINESS PRACTICE
NQF LEVEL 2

(3061002)

18 November 2019 (Y-Paper)
09:00–12:00

This question paper consists of 12 pages.

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TIME: 3 HOURS
MARKS: 150

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Read ALL the questions carefully.
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Start each question on a NEW page.
5. Write neatly and legibly.

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SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 Various options are given as possible answers to the following questions. Choose the answer and write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 Which calculation is correct for the selling price of a product?

A Cost price minus mark-up
B Cost price plus profit
C Cost price plus mark-up
D Cost price minus profit

1.1.2 Technology does NOT include …

A computers.
B merchandise.
C equipment.
D a new machine.

1.1.3 A/An … code prescribes what you wear in a particular situation in the workplace.

A uniform
B ethical
C conduct
D dress

1.1.4 A quality that indicates a negative attitude:

A Being an extrovert
B Exercising emotional control
C Looking for attention
D Being critical about own ability

1.1.5 Choose the INCORRECT answer. When dealing with a person who is HIV positive …

A wear gloves under all circumstances.
B cover wounds at all times.
C wash hands immediately after contact with possibly infected fluids.
D disinfect surfaces and instruments soiled with blood or other body fluids.

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1.1.6 A factor that has an influence on the pricing policy of an enterprise:

A The nature of demand
B Pressure of trade unions
C Publicity
D Form of ownership

1.1.7 Time-wasters in the work environment exclude …

A unclear tasks and priorities.
B maintaining a diary.
C lack of planning.
D unnecessary meetings.

1.1.8 Which business forms part of the tertiary sector?

A Old Mutual
B Edgars
C Markham
D Shoprite

1.1.9 The first step in the purchasing cycle is …

A sourcing suppliers and obtaining quotations.
B making out a requisition.
C obtaining samples.
D placing an order.

1.1.10 An example of an unsafe act:

A Faulty equipment
B Standing for long periods
C Alcohol use in the workplace
D Frequent bending and twisting

(10 × 2) (20)

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1.2 Choose a description from COLUMN B that matches a term in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–K) next to the question number (1.2.1–1.2.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B	
1.2.1	Basic Conditions of Employment Act	A	possibility to be exposed to a possible danger by employees or by people outside the business
1.2.2	Company policy	B	sells goods to the public
1.2.3	Hazard	C	sets out the maximum number of working hours per day
1.2.4	Risk	D	investment in land, vehicles and machinery
1.2.5	Production department	E	anything that can be potentially harmful
1.2.6	Retailer	F	absenteeism and injuries
1.2.7	Wholesaler	G	known as operations
1.2.8	Fixed capital	H	sells goods to retailers
1.2.9	Working capital	I	applies to a specific business
1.2.10	Unforeseen event	J	generated from debtors and stock
		K	ventilation and lighting

(10 × 1) (10)

1.3 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE. Choose the answer and write only 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.20) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.3.1 Plans cannot be reviewed as they need to be adhered to at all times.

1.3.2 Checkers is an example of a wholesaler.

1.3.3 A performance appraisal assists in the identifying of threats.

1.3.4 Bookkeeping is a function of the purchasing department.

1.3.5 A common cold is not an infectious disease.

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1.3.6 All employees will be allowed to use a jack or hoist in the workplace.

1.3.7 Passive smoking occurs when a smoker is exposed to smoke from a smoking zone.

1.3.8 AIDS stand for Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome.

1.3.9 In the event of a bomb threat, assist in trying to find the bomb.

1.3.10 A flat organisational structure has a short chain of command.

1.3.11 A grievance is a complaint laid by the Human Resource Department against an employee.

1.3.12 Publicity is free coverage in the media and always creates a favourable image of an organisation.

1.3.13 Never fight a fire if your back is not turned to an escape exit.

1.3.14 Sitting for periods that are too long may also be seen as an unsafe working condition.

1.3.15 A hazard only refers to unsafe acts.

1.3.16 Values have an influence on ethical diversity.

1.3.17 The golden rule is not to become involved in an argument with an arrogant visitor.

1.3.18 An unexpected guest cannot expect to be treated with the same respect as any other visitor.

1.3.19 Whistling can be seen as a form of sexual harassment.

1.3.20 The administrative department is a support service which interacts closely with all other departments in the organisation.

(20 × 1) (20)
[50]

TOTAL SECTION A 50

SECTION B

Answer ALL the questions in SECTION B.

QUESTION 2

2.1 Read the following article on sexual harassment and answer the questions.

HAS THE RISK OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT INCREASED IN THE WORKPLACE?

International research points to weakening economic conditions leading to an increase in sexual harassment in the workplace.

Not surprisingly, during such tough financial times, victims of sexual harassment worry about job security, resulting in severe underreporting.

In the wake of South Africa's two recent ratings downgrades to junk status and the prospect of a recession in the future, the country faces a real risk of increased workplace abuse of this nature. Action needs to be taken to limit the effect that this extremely damaging behaviour has on their employees, organisations and reputations.

Even though South Africa has very strict employment legislation to protect workers from unfair labour practices, such incidents have the potential of causing a lot of damage. The difference between officially reported figures of sexual harassment and the reality in workplaces is staggering. About half of women and 10-20% of men are sexually harassed at work, whereas only 6% of those who face harassment actually lodge a complaint.

With the economy under strain, these already-shocking trends are likely to worsen. The detrimental effects of sexual harassment do not end at the victims of such abuses. Organisations take a knock too. This begs the question: What practical steps can be taken to improve victims' reporting behaviour and generally make themselves more accessible to victims?

Adapted from: https://hrfuture.net/articles/strategy/legal/why-has-the-risk-of-sexual-harassment-increased-in-the-workplace downloaded on 6 June 2019.

2.1.1 Briefly define *sexual harassment*. (2)

2.1.2 List any FIVE acts that may be seen as a form of sexual harassment. (5)

2.1.3 Give any TWO reasons why employees do not report cases of sexual harassment. (2)

2.1.4 Which department in a business deals with sexual harassment? (1)

2.1.5 'Organisations take a knock too.' Give any TWO possible reasons why this is the case. (2)

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2.2 Look at the following picture and answer the questions.



[Source: https://corporatefinanceinstitute.com/resources/careers/soft-skills/time-management-list-tips/]

2.2.1 What is meant by *time management*? (2)

2.2.2 'Certain tips can be followed for successful time management'. What do you understand by the following? Present your answer in the following format:

TIP	EXPLANATION
Set priorities	
Self-monitor	
Schedule	
Review	

(4)

2.2.3 Name TWO forms of time wasting that may have a negative impact on time management. (2)

2.3 Read the following article and answer the questions.

The Impact of Absenteeism

People miss work for a variety of reasons. Most of the time when employees take time off, it is planned. However, when it is unforeseen and unexpected time off, the absenteeism can have a huge impact on a business.

According to the Bureau of Labour Statistics (BLS), the absenteeism rate from work for full-time employees is 2.9% The impact of absenteeism is certainly a big enough problem that organisations should understand how it affects individuals, teams and organisational performance.

The impact of absenteeism is felt directly by individuals, teams and the entire organisation. Human Resource leaders can make a direct impact on organisational performance and employee morale by discovering and addressing the root causes of absenteeism, and making strides to address those issues.

Adapted from: https://www.adp.com/spark/articles/2017/01/the-impact-of-absenteeism.aspx, downloaded on 6 June 2019.

2.3.1 'Absenteeism does not only refer to not being at work.' Substantiate this statement by listing any FOUR other cases that will also be regarded as being absent. (4)

2.3.2 'The impact of absenteeism is a big enough problem that organisations should understand how it affects individuals, teams and organisational performance'. Name ONE possible effect on everyone. Present your answer as follows:

Party involved	Effect
Individuals	
Teams	
Organisational performance	

(3)

2.3.3 List any other THREE unforeseen circumstances that a business may have to deal with. (3)

2.4 List any SIX benefits of proper time management. (6)

2.5 List any FOUR duties that an employee has to perform as part of his/her work of good practice. (4)

[40]

QUESTION 3

Ishtar Chemical manufactures cleaning products for companies and households. This company is situated along the coast as some of the material/ingredients contain harmful substances that may have a huge impact on the environment. The company has more than 100 employees and appointed health and safety representatives.

3.1 List any FIVE responsibilities that Ishtar Chemical must perform regarding the health and safety of their employees. (5)

3.2 List any THREE duties of a health and safety representative. (3)

3.3 'An employee was injured and bleeding. He disclosed that he is HIV positive.'

3.3.1 What does it mean if a person is HIV positive? (1)

3.3.2 List FOUR precautions that you should consider when handling a person who is HIV positive. (4)

3.4 Ishlar Chemical should have a proper evacuation procedure in place and should also practise this.

List any FIVE elements of an evacuation procedure. (5)

3.5 Name TWO types of emergencies that Ishlar Chemical may have to deal with. (2)

[20]

QUESTION 4

Read the scenario below and answer the questions.

Mr Gou is the new CEO of a family business selling food, clothing and furniture to a small village in a rural area. He is in charge of the business consisting of four managers and nine other employees. The employees report to their respective managers.

The following staff are under his supervision:

Mrs X. Jones – Purchases Manager + 3 employees
Mr V. Mandala – Marketing Manager + 2 employees
Miss J. Pink – Finance Manager + 3 employees
Mr Y. Halls – Human Resource Manager + 1 employee

4.1 Draw an organisational chart (organogram) for this business. (10 × ½) (5)

4.2 Mrs X. Jones needs to have thorough knowledge of the purchasing cycle that she must follow. Assist her by listing the SIX steps in the purchasing cycle in the correct sequence. (6)

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4.3 'The marketing manager should have thorough knowledge of the marketing activities in his/her department.' List FOUR elements of marketing activities. (4)

4.4 List THREE core functions of the Human Resources Department. (3)

4.5 'Mr Gou, currently doing the main administrative tasks himself, decided not to have a separate administration department as it has certain possible disadvantages.'

List any THREE such disadvantages. (3)

4.6 List any FOUR key tasks that Mr Gou has to do as a core part of the all-over administrative function. (4)

[25]

QUESTION 5



[Source: https://www.google.com/search?q=evaluating+your+own+skills+and+identify+your+need+for+development, downloaded on 6 June 2019]

5.1 'An employee must evaluate his/her own skills to ensure continual development. This is done by conducting a skills audit.' What does this mean? (2)

5.2 'Your employer will carry out a performance appraisal to assess your performance.'

Briefly explain what a performance appraisal is. (2)

5.3 List any THREE advantages of skills development. (3)

5.4 'When setting objectives and goals for yourself, the goals should be in line with the objectives of the business. You should also be realistic in setting goals that can be reached. To assist you in this, you can use the SMART approach.



Briefly explain this approach. (5)

5.5 'To be able to reach your objectives, you should also lead a healthy lifestyle.'

List any THREE things that you can do to remain healthy. (3)



[15]

TOTAL SECTION B: 100
GRAND TOTAL: 150

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